

APOCALYPTIVERSE · THE LAST DAY

The Last Day: Origins

A two-part cyberpunk thriller about the bio-digital cost of corporate evolution — set in the walled metropolis of Rivers, where escapism becomes an instrument of control.

Apocalyptiverse presents *The Last Day: Origins*, a cyberpunk thriller set in a near-future society caught between digital pacification and technological vanguardism. In the metropolis of Rivers, a tower of technological progress pierces the skyline and throws its shadow over a sprawl of neglected outskirts and favelas. A miles-long wall encloses not one city but three interconnected ones — a physical barrier between the elite center and the decaying periphery. That divide is the staging ground for a revolution.

The story centers on Silas Midori, a twenty-something factory worker, and Steve Gallagher, a tactical veteran with a shadowed military past. What begins as an attempt to expose Kisonic Enterprises — the corporation that dominates the interactive-entertainment market — spirals into a high-stakes conspiracy. Along the way, Silas discovers a subconscious connection to the machinery around him: not standard telekinesis, but an ability that makes the city's hardware respond to his unspoken commands.

At its core, *Origins* is a critique of immersive technology and corporate surveillance. Through the "New Destiny" arcade system — a full-dive virtual reality experience run by a faceless AI — the series asks where escapism ends and control begins, and what a population trades away for a digital destiny.

Narrative Pillars & World-Building

In a saturated cyberpunk market, *The Last Day* differentiates itself through rigorous internal logic and the plausible evolution of its corporate antagonist. The world-building is the differentiator, and its architecture dictates who survives.

The City of Rivers — A massive, centralized metropolis defined by extreme socio-economic stratification; technology improves the closer you get to the center. An imposing wall masks three interconnected cities from the outskirts of favelas and warehouses.

Kisonic Enterprises — A monolithic "personal experience–alternative technology" corporation. It dominates entertainment by blurring fantasy and reality to generate billions in credits, often at the cost of human leverage.

Full-Dive Virtual Reality — The "New Destiny" system, the peak of Kisonic's tech. It uploads a user's mind into a computer through wires and sensors to play out tailored fantasies, and is managed by the "Young Maiden" (AI Allison), an entity rumored to be truly alive.

The Bridget Protocol — A legacy of Steve's military past: a government tool for "restructuring" and "pacification," once the standard instrument for silencing dissent and processing populations into centralized Rivers City.

Central conflict: the collision between civilian survival and a corporate-led "restructuring" that uses immersive technology to pacify a neglected, evolving population.

Availability

The Last Day: Origins — Issue I 2024 · PRINT & DIGITAL

The 22-page launch issue that opened the Apocalyptiverse. Available on Gumroad (Creator's Cut), Amazon, and GlobalComix.

The Last Day: Origins — Issue II AUGUST 2026 · DIGITAL ONLY

Read now in the Reader Room at apocalyptiverse.com, a full week ahead of retail. On sale August 4 via Gumroad, GlobalComix, and Nerdanatix; Amazon edition to follow later in August.

Official Q&A

1. What is the core premise of *The Last Day: Origins*?

Silas Midori and his mentor Steve Gallagher infiltrate Kisonic Enterprises to uncover the truth behind the "New Destiny" arcade system — an addictive technology used as a tool for societal control in Rivers.

2. How would you describe the City of Rivers?

A sprawling, centralized metropolis defined by a massive wall that shields three interconnected cities, with a stark contrast between a high-tech central core and neglected outskirts of warehouses and favelas.

3. What is Kisonic Enterprises' most controversial product?

The "New Destiny" arcade system — a highly addictive, full-dive VR experience that captures the public imagination while raising ethical concerns about mind-uploading and the nature of the AI governing the game.

4. Who is Silas Midori?

A twenty-something factory worker at the center of a corporate conspiracy. He possesses a burgeoning, subconscious technopathic ability that lets him interface with machinery, making code and hardware respond to his unspoken commands.

5. What role does Steve Gallagher play?

Silas's experienced tactical mentor — a man burdened by a dark military past involving the "Bridget Protocol." Silas experiences a visceral sense of betrayal upon discovering Steve's secret life as the Iron Knight.

6. Who is the "Iron Knight"?

A heavily armored, unregistered vigilante operating in the Braker District. The public sees him as a keeper of justice who clears out narcotics cells; the N.E.O. oversight body labels him an unauthorized operator and a threat to civil mandates.

7. What is the "Bridget Protocol"?

A government tool for the "restructuring" and "pacification" of cities, designed to ensure silence and process dissenters during the centralization that eventually formed Rivers.

8. How does the "New Destiny" VR system function?

A full-dive system that connects to the user through sensors and wires, uploading their consciousness into a computer. It entices the imagination, letting users live out fantasies for an allotted time at a price of billions of credits.

9. Who is the "Young Maiden," AI Allison?

The learning AI that manages the VR program. Often depicted as a faceless, ethereal maiden, closer observation reveals a more malicious nature — demonic eyes and a malicious grin.

10. What are "TKs" in this world?

Telekinetic individuals, viewed with fear and scrutiny. Silas is often suspected of being a TK, but his actual ability — interfacing with and subconsciously commanding machinery — makes him a far more specific threat to Kisonic.

11. Who is the primary corporate antagonist?

Vance Doyle, a high-level Kisonic executive and surgical operative involved in corruption and illegal tech deals. He extracts human leverage by kidnapping individuals — including Silas's own mother.

12. What can readers expect from the visual style and tone?

Gritty, high-frequency action. A unique visual identifier is the "ethereal vision" used in VR sequences — thin trails of steam and smoke that distinguish digital fantasies from the smoke and mud of the real world.

Credits

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